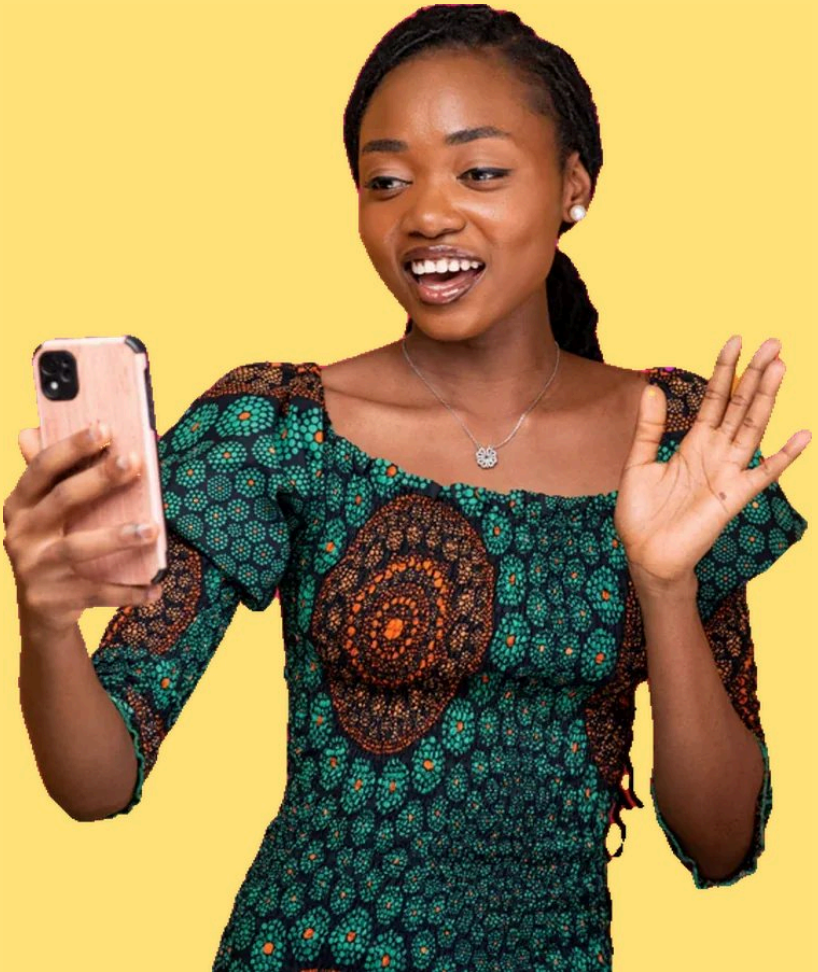
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Packing and Delivery Decision Toolkit

Choosing how your orders get packed and delivered is one of your first big decisions as an online seller. This toolkit compares three ways: delivering yourself, dropshipping, or using...



7 pages · PDF

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What's inside

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Choosing how your orders get packed and delivered is one of your first big decisions as an online seller. This toolkit compares three ways: delivering yourself, dropshipping, or using a fulfilment service (a company that stores, packs and delivers your goods for you, also called a "3PL").

01 Quick Start: Which Method Fits You?

First, answer these three questions:

1. **How much money can you put in at the start?** (Under ₦300,000, ₦300,000–₦1.5 million, or above ₦1.5 million)
2. **How many hours a week can you give the business?** (5 hours, 10–20 hours, or 20+ hours)
3. **What is your 6-month goal?** (Test ideas, steady side income, or a full-time business)

Your answers point you in the right direction. Now let's look at each option.

02 Self-Delivery Checklist

Start by delivering yourself if you tick 3 or more boxes:

- ☐ You have less than ₦500,000 to start
- ☐ You get fewer than 50 orders a month
- ☐ You have space at home or in a shop for stock
- ☐ You want full control over your packaging
- ☐ You sell handmade or customised products (adire, beaded jewellery, body butter)
- ☐ You have 10+ hours a week to pack and arrange delivery
- ☐ You live near a GIG Logistics office or good dispatch riders
- ☐ You want to learn the business hands-on

What you'll need to start:

- A small parcel scale
- Packaging (nylon mailers, boxes, tape, logo stickers)
- Delivery partners: local dispatch riders, plus GIG Logistics, Kwik Delivery or Sendbox
- Shelves or bins to keep stock organised
- A Google Sheet to track orders

Cost reality: Expect about ₦30,000–₦100,000 for first supplies. Then each order costs packaging plus delivery. For example, a dispatch rider within Lagos might charge ₦2,000–₦5,000; other states cost more. Many sellers add delivery to the bill or offer pay on delivery.

03 Dropshipping Checklist

Dropshipping means the supplier sends the product straight to your customer. You never hold stock.

Consider dropshipping if you tick 3 or more boxes:

- ☐ You have under ₦300,000 to start
- ☐ You want to test many products quickly
- ☐ You don't have space for stock
- ☐ You are happy with smaller profit per sale (often 20–40%)
- ☐ Your customers can wait a few days for delivery
- ☐ You want little physical work
- ☐ You are patient with suppliers
- ☐ You are comfortable using apps to place and track orders

What you'll need to start:

- An online store. Shopinbos is free to start: Rex builds your store, and verified Nigerian suppliers can dropship for you.
- Reliable suppliers. Imports from 1688 or Alibaba through an agent take weeks, so they suit wholesale better.
- A small ad budget (₦30,000–₦150,000) for Instagram, TikTok or Facebook
- A way to reply customers fast on WhatsApp and Instagram

Cost reality: You pay for products only after they sell, but profit per order is lower. Budget for ads and data. Foreign tools are often billed in US dollars, so watch the exchange rate.

04 Fulfilment Service Checklist

A fulfilment service keeps your stock in its warehouse, then packs and delivers each order. Some Nigerian logistics companies offer this.

Consider a fulfilment service if you tick 3 or more boxes:

- ☐ You ship 100+ orders a month
- ☐ You have ₦2 million or more for stock
- ☐ You want to focus on sales, not packing
- ☐ Customers expect delivery in 1–3 days across many cities
- ☐ Your products have good profit (40% or more)
- ☐ You are ready to buy stock in bulk

- ☐ You want professional storage
- ☐ You plan to grow fast

What you'll need to start:

- A trusted partner with good reviews (visit their warehouse if you can)
- Your first bulk stock
- A link between your store and the partner
- A simple way to track stock
- Cash for monthly fees

Cost reality: Expect monthly storage fees and a charge per order packed, on top of stock. Ask for a written price list. More orders make each one cheaper.

05 Your Decision Framework

Use these guides to judge your situation:

Money

- Under ₦300,000 = Dropshipping or self-delivery
- ₦300,000–₦1.5 million = Self-delivery with your own stock
- ₦1.5 million–₦3 million = Self-delivery or a small fulfilment partner
- Above ₦3 million = A fulfilment service becomes realistic

Time

- Under 5 hours a week = Dropshipping or a fulfilment service
- 10–20 hours a week = Any method works
- 20+ hours a week = Self-delivery to learn, then grow

Orders

- 0–30 a month = Self-delivery
- 30–100 a month = Self-delivery or dropshipping
- 100–500 a month = Consider a fulfilment service
- 500+ a month = Definitely a fulfilment service

06 Making Your Choice: Action Steps

Step 1: Fill in all three checklists honestly.

Step 2: Work out your true costs, including your time. If packing and calling riders takes 3 hours and your time is worth ₦2,000 an hour, that is ₦6,000 in real cost.

Step 3: Start with the method that ticked the most boxes. You can change later.

Step 4: Set a review date 3 months away to check if your method still makes sense.

Step 5: Write down every step you take. You'll need these notes when you switch.

07 Common Mistakes to Avoid

Beginners often:

- **Underestimate the time** self-delivery takes (packing and chasing riders take longer than you think)
- **Expect a fulfilment service to be cheap** with few orders (fees eat profit quickly)
- **Dropship without checking suppliers** (leading to late deliveries and complaints)
- **Switch methods too quickly** (give each one at least 60 days)

08 Your Next Move

You now have clear checklists and a simple way to compare all three options. Pick the method that ticked the most boxes, gather what you need, and start selling.

Remember: most successful sellers start with one method and change as they grow. Your first choice teaches you about your customers, so you can grow smarter later.

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Ready to make your first sale?

Rex builds your store with you in 5 minutes. Take card, transfer and pay on delivery, book riders, and let Peggy answer customers on WhatsApp.

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